

Chapter 10

Number Theory

Well-Ordering Principle: Every non-empty subset of non-negative integers set has a minimum element.

10.1 Definition

Definition 10.1.1. Let $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$ be integers.

We said to be b divides a if: $a = bx$ for some $x \in \mathbb{Z}$. Denote $b \mid a$.

10.2 The Division Algorithm

Theorem 10.2.1. Let $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$ be integers with $b > 0$. Then, there exists unique integers $q, r \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that

$$a = b \cdot q + r \quad (0 \leq r < b)$$

Proof. Let $S \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \{a - bx \mid x \in \mathbb{Z}, a - bx \geq 0\}$. Then, S is non-empty because $a - b \cdot (-|a|) = a + |a|b \geq a + |a| \geq 0$. Thus, Well-Ordering Principle gives that there exists a minimum element of S . Put $r = \min S$. (That is, for any $k \in S$, $r \leq k$.) Since $r \in S$, there exists $q \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $r = a - bq \geq 0$. To show $r < b$, we will use Contradiction. Suppose that $r \geq b$. Then,

$$a - b \cdot (q + 1) = a - bq - b = r - b \geq 0$$

Thus, $a - b(q + 1) \in S$, but this is contradiction with $r = a - bq$ is a minimum element of S .

To show the Uniqueness, there exist $q, q', r, r' \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that

$$a = bq + r = bq' + r' \quad (0 \leq r, r' < b)$$

Then, $b|q - q'| = |r - r'|$, thus must be $q = q'$ and $r = r'$. □

Corollary 10.2.2. Let $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$ be integers with $b \neq 0$. Then, there exists unique integers $q, r \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that

$$a = b \cdot q + r \quad (0 \leq r < |b|)$$

10.3 Bézout's Identity

Definition 10.3.1. Let $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$ be integers. The integer d is called *The greatest common divisor* of a, b if:

1. $d \mid a$ and $d \mid b$.
2. If $c \mid a$ and $c \mid b$, then $c \leq d$.

Denote $d \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \gcd(a, b)$.

Theorem 10.3.2. Let $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$ be integers. Then, there exist integers $x, y \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that

$$\gcd(a, b) = ax + by$$

Proof. Define a set:

$$S \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \{a \cdot u + b \cdot v \mid u, v \in \mathbb{Z}, a \cdot u + b \cdot v > 0\}$$

Clearly, S is non-empty set. Thus, S has a minimum element $d = \min S$ by Well-Ordering Principle. Since $d \in S$, $d = ax + by$ for some $x, y \in \mathbb{Z}$. By the Division Algorithm, there exist $q, r \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that

$$a = d \cdot q + r \quad (0 \leq r < d)$$

That is,

$$r = a - d \cdot q = a - q \cdot (ax + by) = a \cdot (1 - qx) + b \cdot (-qy)$$

If $r \neq 0$, then $r \in S$ and $r < d$, this is contradiction with $d = \min S$. Thus, $r = 0$.

Similarly, $b = d \cdot q'$ for some $q' \in \mathbb{Z}$. In summary, d divides a and b .

Now, let c be an arbitrary positive common divisor of a and b . Then, c divides $ax + by = d$, thus $c \leq d$. Consequently, $d = \gcd(a, b)$. □

Corollary 10.3.3. Let a, b be integers. For $d = \gcd(a, b)$,

$$\{a \cdot x + b \cdot y \mid x, y \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{d \cdot k \mid k \in \mathbb{Z}\}$$

10.3.1 Extended Euclidean Algorithm

Lemma 10.3.4. Let a, b be integers.

If $a = b \cdot q + r$ with $0 \leq r < b$, then $\gcd(a, b) = \gcd(b, r)$.

Proof. Put $d = \gcd(a, b)$. Since $d \mid a$ and $d \mid b$, d divides $r = a - bq$. That is, d is common divisor of b and r . Meanwhile, let c be a divisor of b and r . Then, c divides $a = bq + r$, thus $c \leq d$. This implies $d = \gcd(b, r)$. $\square$

Consider the given integers a, b . By the Division Algorithm, we can write:

$$\begin{aligned}
 a &= b \cdot q_0 + r_0 & (0 \leq r_0 < b) \\
 b &= r_0 \cdot q_1 + r_1 & (0 \leq r_1 < r_0) \\
 r_0 &= r_1 \cdot q_2 + r_2 & (0 \leq r_2 < r_1) \\
 &\vdots \\
 r_{k-2} &= r_{k-1} \cdot q_k + r_k & (0 \leq r_k < r_{k-1}) \\
 &\vdots \\
 r_{n-2} &= r_{n-1} \cdot q_n + r_n & (0 \leq r_n < r_{n-1}) \\
 r_{n-1} &= r_n \cdot q_{n+1} & (r_{n+1} = 0)
 \end{aligned}$$

Since the Non-negative numbers Sequence $\{r_k\}$ strictly decrease, r_{n+1} must be zero for some $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Put $r_{-2} = a$ and $r_{-1} = b$. Since above Lemma,

$$\gcd(a, b) = \gcd(b, r_0) = \gcd(r_0, r_1) = \cdots = \gcd(r_{n-1}, r_n) = \gcd(r_n, 0) = r_n$$

This implies also for any $-2 \leq k \leq n$, r_k is multiple of r_n .

By Corollary of Bézout's Identity, for any $-2 \leq k \leq n$, there exists $x_k, y_k \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that

$$r_k = a \cdot x_k + b \cdot y_k \quad (*)$$

Since $r_{-2} = a$ and $r_{-1} = b$,

$$\begin{aligned}
 x_{-2} &= 1, \quad y_{-2} = 0 \\
 x_{-1} &= 0, \quad y_{-1} = 1
 \end{aligned}$$

And, substituting $(*)$ to $r_{k-2} - r_{k-1} \cdot q_k = r_k$:

$$a \cdot x_k + b \cdot y_k = a \cdot x_{k-2} + b \cdot y_{k-2} - (a \cdot x_{k-1} + b \cdot y_{k-1}) \cdot q_k = a \cdot (x_{k-2} - x_{k-1} \cdot q_k) + b \cdot (y_{k-2} - y_{k-1} \cdot q_k)$$

Now, we obtain the equation: for all $0 \leq k \leq n$,

$$\begin{aligned}
 x_k &= x_{k-2} - x_{k-1} \cdot q_k \\
 y_k &= y_{k-2} - y_{k-1} \cdot q_k
 \end{aligned}$$

Consequently, to find $x, y \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $\gcd(a, b) = r_n = a \cdot x + b \cdot y = a \cdot x_n + b \cdot y_n$, we simply calculate x_n, y_n inductively.

Lemma. Given non-zero integers $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$,

$ax \equiv b \pmod{n}$ has a solution if and only if $(a, n) \mid b$.

In Particular, if $(a, n) \mid b$, then the equation has exactly (a, n) distinct roots.

Proof. $ax \equiv b \pmod{n}$ for some $x \in \mathbb{Z} \Leftrightarrow n \mid ax - b \Leftrightarrow \exists y \in \mathbb{Z}, ax - b = ny$.

If $(a, n) \nmid b$ and $ax \equiv b \pmod{n}$ has a solution, then

$$ax - ny = b \text{ but } (a, n) \nmid b.$$

But, by the Bézout identity, $ax - ny$ is multiple of (a, n) , so contradiction.

So, $\Rightarrow$ Proved. $\square$

Conversely, if $(a, n) \mid b$, then $b = (a, n) \cdot y$ for some $y \in \mathbb{Z}$.

So, $ax \equiv b \pmod{n} \Leftrightarrow ax - (a, n)y$ is divided by n